

NEEL KOTAK

+1 (808) 753-9778 ◇ DevSecOps Software Engineer ◇ Washington DC ◇ TS/SCI with Polygraph
neelkotak13@gmail.com ◇ linkedin.com/in/neel-kotak/ ◇ github.com/neelkotak13

OBJECTIVE

Technical cybersecurity professional with expertise in consulting on complex solutions for AWS Professional Services (ProServe) customers and 4+ years of experience in the United States Air Force. Deep technical experience with application security reviews and threat modeling, CI/CD SAST code scanning pipelines, AWS service implementation via Infrastructure-as-Code (IaC), advanced threat hunting, malware analysis, and forensics. Current focus on building scalable security solutions via IaC. Seeking technical cybersecurity roles, security engineering positions, and/or software development opportunities where I can leverage deep technical expertise in threat detection/hunting, security automation, DevSecOps practices, and cloud security.

EDUCATION

Master of Cyber Security, Georgia Institute of Technology 2021 - 2025
Relevant Coursework: Advanced Malware Analysis, Network Security, Information Policy and Management, Secure Computing Systems, Applied Cryptography, Information Security Lab: System and Network Defenses

Bachelor of Computer Science, University of Hawaii at Manoa 2015 - 2019

CERTIFICATIONS

CompTIA Security+ - May 2020
GCFA - Aug 2021; **GCIH** - Jan 2023
Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) - Jan 2025
DoD 8570: IAT Level III | CSSP Analyst | Incident Responder
AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional (SAP) - Oct 2025

SKILLS

Security Tools & Practices	Threat Modeling (STRIDE, DREAD, PASTA), SAST/SCA Scanning (cdk_nag, cfn_nag, trivy, semgrep, checkov, bandit, git-secrets), Forensic Analysis, Penetration Testing
Infrastructure as Code	Terraform, AWS CDK (Python/TypeScript), CloudFormation
Programming/Scripting	Python, Bash, Java, C/C++
AWS Services	Compute (EC2, Lambda), Storage (S3), Security (SecurityHub, GuardDuty), AI/ML (Bedrock), Networking (API Gateway, Network Firewall), Governance (LZA), Automation (Boto3)

EXPERIENCE

AWS Professional Services Consultant Dec 2024 - Present
Amazon Web Services (AWS) *Washington DC, Maryland, and Virginia Metropolitan Area (DMV)*

- Led comprehensive AWS GuardDuty/SecurityHub workshop for 15+ customer security personnel, delivering hands-on training on EventBridge integration, automated remediation workflows, and suppression best practices, resulting in overwhelmingly positive feedback and enhanced customer security automation practices
- Configured and deployed DISA STIG-hardened Palo Alto firewall infrastructure with AWS Gateway Load Balancers (GWLBs) across 5+ DoD workload accounts in air-gapped dev/test/prod environments via AWS LZA cloudformation IaC, enabling mission critical DoD cloud migration by delivering highly-scalable, highly-available (HA), resilient networking solution ready for customer workload onboarding and deployment
- Deployed keycloak identity management solution via AWS ECS Fargate clusters across 5+ DoD workload accounts in air-gapped dev/test/prod environments, enabling PKI-based multi-factor authentication and compliance requirements for mission-critical applications through highly-scalable, resilient containerized architecture

- Implemented and customized AWS SecurityHub Compliance Analyzer (SHCA) for DoD customer's air-gapped Amazon Dedicated Cloud (ADC) environment, modifying CDK typescript/python code to handle air-gapped region-specific DNS configurations and VPC endpoint limitations, enabling automated weekly/monthly NIST 800-53 compliance reporting and documentation uploads across dev/test/prod accounts
- Conducted security reviews for 10+ ProServe projects using threat modeling (STRIDE, DREAD, PASTA) and automated SAST scanning (cdk_nag, cfn_nag, trivy, semgrep, checkov, bandit, git-secrets), identifying and resolving 2-5 critical/high vulnerabilities per project while creating standardized templates and leveraging AWS Automated Security Helper (ASH) scanner along with generative AI to achieve significant efficiency gains in security analysis and artifact generation
- Designed and implemented complex, scalable, and secure AWS solutions tailored to customer needs

Cyber Protection Team Mission Element Lead (CPT MEL)

May 2020 - Aug 2024

U.S. Air Force

San Antonio, TX

- Led 10+ member teams on rogue systems investigations for proactive threat hunting on multiple networks spanning over 3000+ endpoints and petabytes of network traffic, uncovering novel APTs Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs) which deterred, disrupted, and degraded cyber actors
- Extensive experience with memory and disk based forensic artifacts, including use of volatility, FTK imager, and KAPE forensics for intensive analysis of disk and memory images
- Directed and analyzed countless suspicious and malicious binaries via static and behavioral analysis, enhancing total industry knowledge of sophisticated threat actors
- Wrote extensive python and powershell scripts to automate and search IOCs across large data sets for malicious activity, which amplified efficiency and number of findings across multiple missions
- Wrote multiple technical reports that focused on threat actor findings, assessed network security posture, and recommended mitigation for network referencing NIST 800-53 guidance, bolstering network defenses and reducing adversary attack surface
- Created, reviewed and validated detection rules team playbook for use in ELK stack to enhance detection of IOCs, which reduced indications of false positives

PRE-PUBLICATION REVIEW CASE NUMBER: RES-2026-00414